

Prader-Willi Syndrome

It is a genetic condition caused by the absence of chromosomal material.

Characteristics of the syndrome include developmental delays, poor muscle tone, short stature, small hands and feet, incomplete sexual development, and unique facial features.

Insatiable appetite leading to **obesity** is the classic feature of PWS

Early dietary treatment starting at the second year of life and continued until the age of 10 years is effective in avoiding excessive weight gain but results in shorter stature.

Persons with PWS may be more sensitive; small doses of herbs and drugs may cause a greater reaction than in other people .Therefore, **herbs and botanicals** should not be used.

INTERVENTION:

- Use 10 to 11 kcal/cm of height to maintain weight; 8.5 kcal/cm for slow weight loss.
- For older teens, reduce the total calorie level to 7 to 8 kcal/cm for weight loss, or 10 to 14 kcal/cm to maintain. Patients' needs are about 60% of those without PWS.
- Ensure that the diet provides adequate protein and nutrients with recommended daily allowances for age.

- The Prader-Willi pyramid recommends: three to five servings from the bread group; four fruit servings; two servings from the dairy group; two to three servings of protein foods (2 to 3 oz each); and several servings from the vegetable group per day.

MNT of children and adults with PWS requires follow-up with many health care providers and schools.

Fortunately parents of the individual with PWS now have access to a number of support groups and organizations dedicated to education, research, and establishing treatment programs.



Fig. 43.5 Child with Prader-Willi syndrome.

References

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FOOD & THE
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E I G H T H E D I T I O N

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